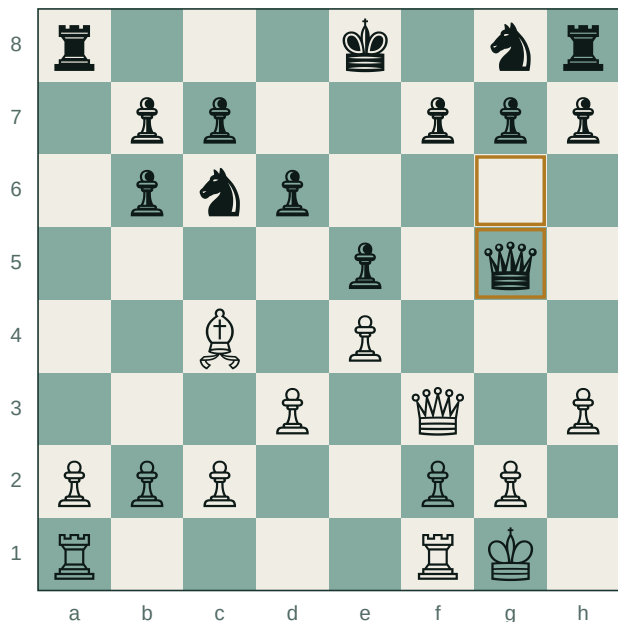


Skewers: White, move 12

Skewers

White to move



Previous move: 11...Qxg5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12. Qxf7+ Kd8 13. Qf8+ Kd7 14. Qxa8

12.Qxf7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f7 it attacks king on e8 and knight on g8. Recorded reply: **12...Kd8**.

13.Qf8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f8 it attacks king on d8 and knight on g8. Recorded reply: **13...Kd7**.

14.Qxa8 The queen captures the rook on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 30 / Black 27 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.